

Identity Theft Recovery Guide

Identity theft occurs when someone takes your personal information without your permission. This information may include your Social Security number, Medicare number, driver's license number, credit card information, or other sensitive information. Scammers may use this information to make purchases or commit fraud in your name.

If you are a victim of identity theft, it is important to follow these steps:

1. Contact Your Financial Institution

If your banking or credit card information has been compromised, call your bank and credit card company immediately. Report the unauthorized transactions from your accounts and request a replacement card if necessary. You can also ask them about any additional fraud protection options that might be available.

2. Change Your Passwords

Immediately change the passwords for your compromised accounts. If available, try to also enable two-factor authentication.

3. Report the Identity Theft

Report the identity theft to the appropriate organizations. You can refer to the Scam Reporting Directory for more information about where to report identity theft and related fraud.

4. Monitor Your Financial Accounts

Keep a close eye on your bank statements, credit card statements, and investment accounts. Look for anything unfamiliar and suspicious and report it immediately.

5. Watch Your Credit

Monitor your credit reports to examine if any new accounts were created, if there are loans that you did not apply for, or if there were changes to your

personal information on the account. If necessary, consider placing a fraud alert or credit freeze on your credit file.

Recovering from identity theft often takes time. It may require several phone calls or follow-ups. Always keep copies of all reports and evidence of the scam. Keeping organized records can make the recovery process easier.